

won't necessarily show, like perfume or brand changes on basic items. Buying in bulk, whether generally for the freezer, or with an assembly-cooking strategy in mind, can be a great way to carve out extra cash as well.

These tips only scratch the surface. Frugal discipline does not have to mean deprivation. It is possible to have a life of abundance without spending more money than you'd care to. — **Myscha Theriault**

A Sneaky Way to Win eBay Auctions and Save a Fortune

Many people find that eBay.com is a fabulous resource. Not only can you find almost anything, but you can usually get it a whole lot cheaper. Usually.

There are, of course, many ways for the savvy shopper to turn that "usually" into an "always," and in the case of eBay, it's sniping an auction.

So, what is sniping? Well, it's a nasty word, but the explanation is simple. In a regular eBay auction you place a bid (up to your max) on an item you want. If other parties are interested in that item, you may get into something called a bidding war. And for the frugal shopper, that's your basic nightmare. The price rockets, and before you know it, you're almost paying the cost of retail. Ouch.

With sniping, you place a bid at the very last second, to avoid the bidding war altogether. If the other party doesn't know you're planning on bidding, he/she may be less inclined to place a high bid. Slip in your bid at the last possible second and no one else has the time to decide to outbid you.

This is also effective in managing your ceiling price (you won't fall into the temptation to bid just a little bit more than you planned on, because you've been outbid by a few bucks). If your final offer is still under the highest bidder, you can let the item go without any regrets.

There are two ways you can snipe on eBay. You can do this manually, which means constantly refreshing your browser and then timing your submission just right (remember you have to give the system time to process your bid). It's a little more stressful, and can take some practice, but it's free.